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The good times

I could couch this chapter in a whole bunch of safe-sounding euphemisms, but given the book's title, I'll get straight to the point, shall I? Two words: 'women' and 'booze'.

Whatever else has happened in my life, I can say one thing for sure: I have had a huge amount of fun in my cricket career. Three things have undoubtedly contributed to this: 1) I'm a friendly and outgoing guy who's comfortable in anyone's company; 2) I have the gift of the gab, which I get from my dad, and clearly women love it. My open demeanour often comes across as flirting, but that's just the way I am. I guess you could say I am charming and, as I said, chicks dig it; 3) And this is the double-edged sword – I like to drink, and alcohol has only exacerbated points 1 and 2. It has lubricated some of the best evenings of my life, but it also nearly ended my international career in 2008.

We'll get to that in the next chapter, though. For now, let me tell you about some of the fun stuff. Parents … send your kids to bed.

The Aussie tour of 1997/98

As far as women are concerned, the Proteas' tour to Australia from December 1997 to January 1998 was like going shopping. To this day, the tour remains the most 'successful' one I've ever been on, by a long shot. The guys couldn't believe it – especially some of the single guys who were touring Oz for the first time.

From the day we set foot there, women were falling into our laps virtually every night. Australian women, I can tell you, are not afraid to speak their minds and make it crystal-clear what they're after. Especially, as